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Truce to end if hostages not freed by Saturday

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

The ceasefire between Hamas and Israel appeared increasingly fragile yesterday after US President Donald Trump warned “all hell” would break loose unless Hamas releases every Israeli hostage by the weekend.

“As far as I’m concerned, if all of the hostages aren’t returned by Saturday 12 o’clock — I think it’s an appropriate time — I would say cancel it and all bets are off and let hell break out,” Trump said.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu joined in, saying, “If Hamas does not return our hostages by Saturday noon, the ceasefire will end, and the IDF (Israeli military) will resume intense fighting until Hamas is decisively defeated.”

Tensions high

Trump’s threat came hours after Hamas said the next hostage release due to take place on Saturday would be “postponed until further notice”. The truce saw five groups of Israeli hostages freed in exchange for hundreds of Palestinian prisoners. But tensions spiked after Trump proposed taking over Gaza and removing its more than two million inhabitants.

UN chief Antonio Guterres called on Hamas to proceed with planned releases of hostages and avoid resumption of hostilities that would lead to immense tragedy.

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UAE sounds a clarion call to end wars and conflicts

AL GERGAWI WARNS AGAINST CYBER WARFARE AT WORLD GOVERNMENTS SUMMIT

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The World Governments Summit (WGS) 2025 kicked off yesterday with a wake-up call against wars and conflicts.

Mohammad Bin Abdullah Al Gergawi, Minister of Cabinet Affairs and Chairman of the World Governments Summit Organisation, welcomed the gathering with a powerful opening speech that shook the audience with the stark realities of certain governments repeating the same mistakes of resorting to wars and conflicts over the past 25 years.

Al Gergawi said that humanity is at a pivotal moment, having completed 25 years of a millennium that has witnessed major technological, economic, and social transformations.

However, the most striking account of the history was the destruction caused by wars and conflicts as shown in a video played on the giant screen. “More than 2 million lives were lost to war and conflicts with approximately 120 million displaced as refugees. Only four per cent of conflicts have resulted in peace agreements,” he said.

Transformative impact

Al Gergawi noted that while 25 years ago, the world feared nuclear wars, today, the greatest concern lies in cyber warfare.

Meanwhile, Professor Klaus Schwab, Chairman of the Board of Trustees of the World Economic Forum, emphasised the urgent



Courtesy: Dubai Media Office

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai; Shaikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court; Shaikh Khalid Bin Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi; Shaikh Ahmad Abdullah Al Ahmad Al Sabah, Prime Minister of Kuwait, and Andrzej Duda, President of Poland, attend the World Governments Summit (WGS) 2025 in Dubai yesterday.

More than 2 million lives were lost to war and conflicts with approximately 120 million displaced as refugees. Only four per cent of conflicts have resulted in peace agreements.”

Mohammad Bin Abdullah Al Gergawi

need for global governmental cooperation in navigating the rapidly evolving intelligent age. Schwab commended the UAE’s foresight in appointing an AI minister in 2017, recognising the transformative impact of these technologies on all aspects of life.

During a thought-provoking discussion, Omar Sultan Al

Olama, UAE Minister of State for Artificial Intelligence, Digital Economy, and Remote Work Applications, and Vice Chair of WGS and Robin Li, Co-founder and CEO of Baidu, the company behind Ernie Bot, China’s first public ChatGPT-like AI application, discussed the challenges posed by the rapid advancements in AI.

They also explored how emerging technologies are shaping the future of autonomous driving and cloud computing.

Meanwhile, Day 1 saw WGS being addressed by prime ministers of various countries. Prime Minister of Pakistan, Shehbaz Sharif called for stronger international partnerships to support Pakistan’s ambitious energy and climate goals, which will require an estimated \$100 billion in investment. Sharif also revealed the ambitious goal of achieving a 60 per cent clean energy mix by 2030, while also targeting the transition of 30 per cent of vehicles to electric mobility.

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